



Fig. 9: DKIM/SPF authentication and validation failed

into difficulties, and vice versa. Fig. 8 shows the e-mail sent using DKIM and how the decision is taken to pass it to inbox or spam. To see the DKIM signature and SPF record, you can go to your e-mail client (Gmail or Yahoo) and invoke the view full header option. In Fig. 9, we can see that the DKIM/SPF e-mail authentication failed. SPF shows that there is a permanent error in processing of domain of ICICI bank. The sample e-mail in Fig. 9 is a phishing attack mail which came to the spam folder of my e-mail. It arrived in my spam folder as the SPF/DKIM processing failed. In Fig. 10, we can see an e-mail sent from rakesh_shuklas@yahoo.com to rakesh_shuklas@yahoo.com, which is a self-mail sent by me. The e-mail passed both DKIM and SPF.

Now we will discuss some tips which can be address, accessing, browsing and using e-mail and e-mail accounts.

Properly managing your e-mail accounts

1. Using just one e-mail account. E-mail users often think that their e-mail accounts, like their home address, should have only one e-mail address. A good rule of thumb for the average e-mail user is to have separate e-mail accounts for work and personal requirements and an e-mail account for general use like signing up for newslet-

ters and posting e-mail account for online activities, such as blogs and online forums.

2. Closing the browser after logging out. When checking e-mail at a library or cyber-café, one not only needs to log out of the e-mail but also needs to close the browser window completely. Some e-mail services

display the username (but not your password) even after logging out. Whilst the service does this for convenience, it compromises your e-mail security.

3. Forgetting to delete browser cache, history and passwords. After using a public terminal, it is important to delete the browser cache, history and passwords. Most browsers automatically keep track of all the Web pages that have been visited, and some keep track of any passwords and personal information that were entered in order to help out to fill similar forms in the future. If this information falls into the wrong hands, it can lead to identity theft and stolen bank and e-mail information.

Because the stakes are so high, it is important that Internet users be aware of how to clear a public computer's browser cache so that they can delete private information before lurking hackers get hold of it. In Mozilla's Firefox, simply press Ctrl+Shift+Del. Opera users need to go to Tools>>Delete Private Data. Users of Microsoft's Internet Explorer need to go to Tools>>Internet Options then click the 'Clear History,' 'Delete Cookies' and 'Delete Files' buttons.

4. Using unsecured e-mail accounts to send and receive sensitive corporate information. Large corporations invest huge amounts of money to ensure that their computer networks and e-mails remain secure.

Despite their efforts, careless employees using personal e-mail accounts to conduct company business can pass along sensitive data and can undermine the security measures in place. So ensure that company's security is not risked by transmitting sensitive company data via personal computer or e-mail address.

E-mailing the right people

1. Use the blind carbon copy (BCC) option. When BCC: option is used, rather than the CC:, none of the recipients can see the addresses of the other e-mail recipients. E-mail users often rely too much on the TO because it is the default way of sending e-mails. This is fine as long as writing to just one person or a few family members. But if you are sending a mail out to a diverse group of people, it raises some serious privacy and security concerns.

It takes just one spammer to get a hold of the e-mail and immediately everyone on your e-mail list gets spammed. I am not saying that honesty of the group is in question. There are many e-mail programs that are set up to automatically add to the address books any incoming e-mail addresses. That means that some people in the group will inadvertently have added the entire list to their address book and, as a result, if one of their computers is infected with 'Zombie' (used for distributed denial of service attack) and silently sends out spam e-mails, it will cause the entire list to get spammed.

2. Using the 'Reply All' button. Sometimes the mistake is not in deciding between CC: and BCC: but between hitting 'Reply All' instead of 'Reply.' When using Reply All, it is to be kept in mind that e-mail message is sent to everyone included on the original e-mail and, if the information is strategic in nature, this step can be disastrous from both a security and personal humiliation perspective.

3. Spamming as a result of forwarding e-mail. Forwarding e-mails can be a great way to quickly bring